

Review of the Authentication and Profile Planning Document

1. Timing Issues & Unrealistic Deadlines

Strengths:

- Well-defined phases: The implementation is structured into three phases (Initial Design, Planned Changes, Best Case Features).
- Incremental feature rollout: Core authentication is planned first, followed by enhancements and optimizations.
- Security measures: Plans for hashed passwords, session management, and multi-factor authentication are included.

Issues:

- No clear deadlines are provided for each phase.
- No buffer time for debugging after feature integration.
- Leaderboard and matchmaking integration could be delayed if authentication is not stable.

Suggestions:

- Define specific deadlines for each phase to ensure timely execution.
- Allocate time for testing/debugging before finalizing an implementation phase.
- Prioritize authentication stability before integrating with matchmaking and the leaderboard.

2. Risks That Could Impact Completion

Dependencies Between Tasks:

- Authentication must be fully functional before other features (leaderboard, matchmaking, game history) can be integrated.
- Security features (OAuth, multi-factor authentication) might require more time and testing than planned.
- Database setup is a critical dependency without it, tracking game history and leaderboard rankings is impossible.

Risk Mitigation:

- Complete authentication and user session management first before working on dependent features.
- Parallel test database operations while implementing authentication to ensure seamless integration.
- Include a fallback plan for OAuth in case external authentication services cause delays.

Resource Allocation Issues:

- Security implementations require specialized knowledge if not assigned properly, this may cause delays.

Suggested Solutions:

- Clearly assign responsibilities within the team.
- Have a dedicated security-focused member to handle OAuth and password hashing.
- Introduce peer reviews after each phase to catch security vulnerabilities early.

3. Suggestions for Timeline & Task Order

Strengths:

- Logical implementation order: Basic authentication is set up first, followed by security improvements, and then leaderboard/matchmaking integration.
- Database design included early: Ensures proper user tracking before other features rely on it.

Areas for Improvement:

- No clear deadlines are provided.
- Security implementation should be tested earlier rather than leaving it to later phases.
- Matchmaking and leaderboard should be tested in parallel with authentication to avoid last-minute issues.

4. Final Verdict

What Works Well:

- Structured three-phase approach ensures step-by-step progress.
- Security measures are considered (hashed passwords, session management, OAuth).

- Integration with other teams (game logic, leaderboard, matchmaking) is planned.

What Needs Improvement:

- No clear deadlines are provided milestones should be broken down into specific dates.
- Testing phases are not well-defined security and database interactions need earlier testing.
- Dependencies are not explicitly addressed authentication should be completed before dependent features.

Final Recommendations:

- Add concrete deadlines for each phase to track progress.
- Introduce overlapping testing and debugging periods instead of leaving everything for the last phase.
- Clearly assign tasks to ensure workload distribution is balanced.